

UPWORK PORTFOLIO CASE STUDY

Omits Finance

Designing Trust, Transparency & Speed into Cross-Border Remittance

Cross-border remittance is broken, hurting migrant workers, international students, and cross-border families who pay an average of 6.4% to 11.99% per transfer while waiting days for settlement. As sole product designer and manager, I owned this end-to-end: conducting research across three user segments, mapping the full money flow across banking rails, and shipping the product to an active 500+ user beta across Canada, Nigeria, Ghana, and the UK.

ROLE & SCOPE

Product Lead & Sole Product Designer

CLIENT / ORGANIZATION

Omits Technology Limited (UK)

ENGAGEMENT & TIMELINE

Full-time · 12 Months (2025–2026)

KEY DELIVERABLES

Mobile App (iOS/Android), Design System, Money Flow Engine

500+

Beta Users Onboarded

< 60s

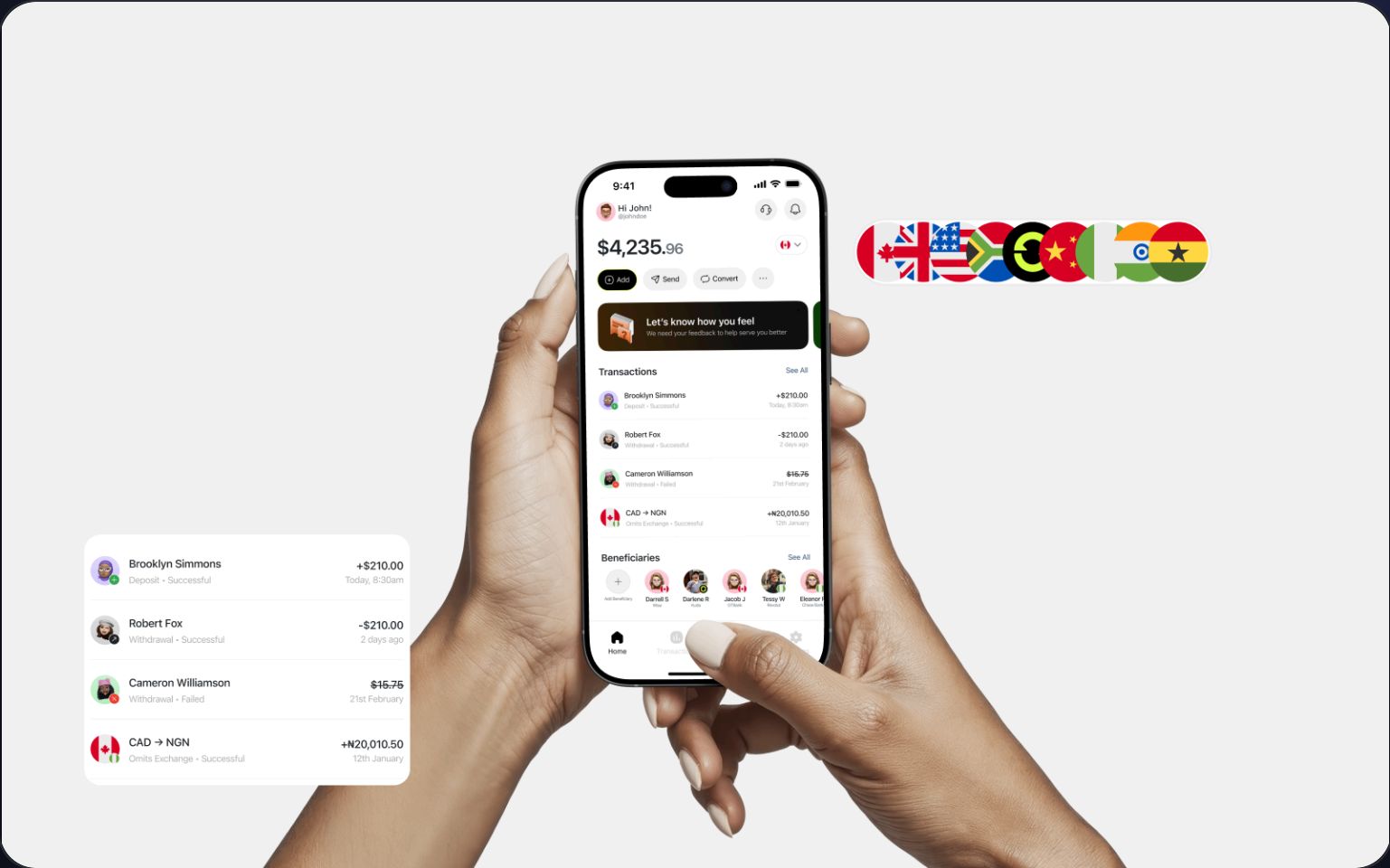
Transaction Completion

130s

Onboarding Completion

4+

Corridors at Launch



■ PROBLEM FRAMING

The Challenge & Friction Points

One app. Multiple countries. Wildly different regulations. Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN), Central Bank of Kenya (CBK), and Bank of Ghana (BoG) each enforce different KYC tiers, document requirements, and transaction limits. Traditional KYC flows were aggressive, demanding everything upfront and killing signup before users saw value. Furthermore, first-time fintech users had high fraud anxiety—excessive fields felt like a scam.

◆ Target User Segments & Stakeholders

Migrant Workers

Sending urgent monthly family support; prioritized transaction speed, absolute fee transparency, and receipt certainty.

International Students

Managing living expenses and tuition from overseas; needed predictable FX rates and low fees.

Small Business Importers

Frequent cross-border inventory payments requiring reliable verification and instant delivery receipts.

■ STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Core Design Principles

01 Radical Transparency

Live FX rate, transfer fees, and the exact recipient amount are explicitly stated before commitment—never hidden in post-transaction deductions.

02 Frictionless Flow

Every step is a potential drop-off. Flows adapt dynamically per corridor: Ghanaian mobile-money asks for operator/number; Nigerian transfer asks for bank/account.

03 Progressive Trust

Tiered KYC defers heavy verification until required by transaction limits, allowing users to experience product value before uploading documents.

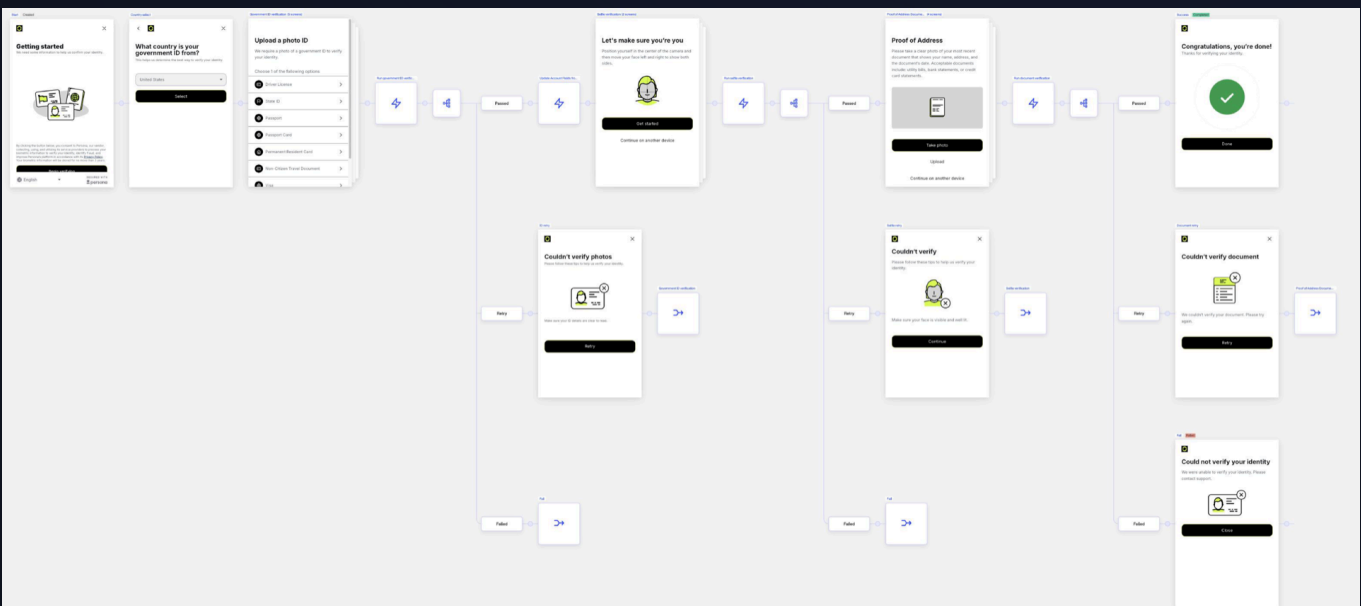
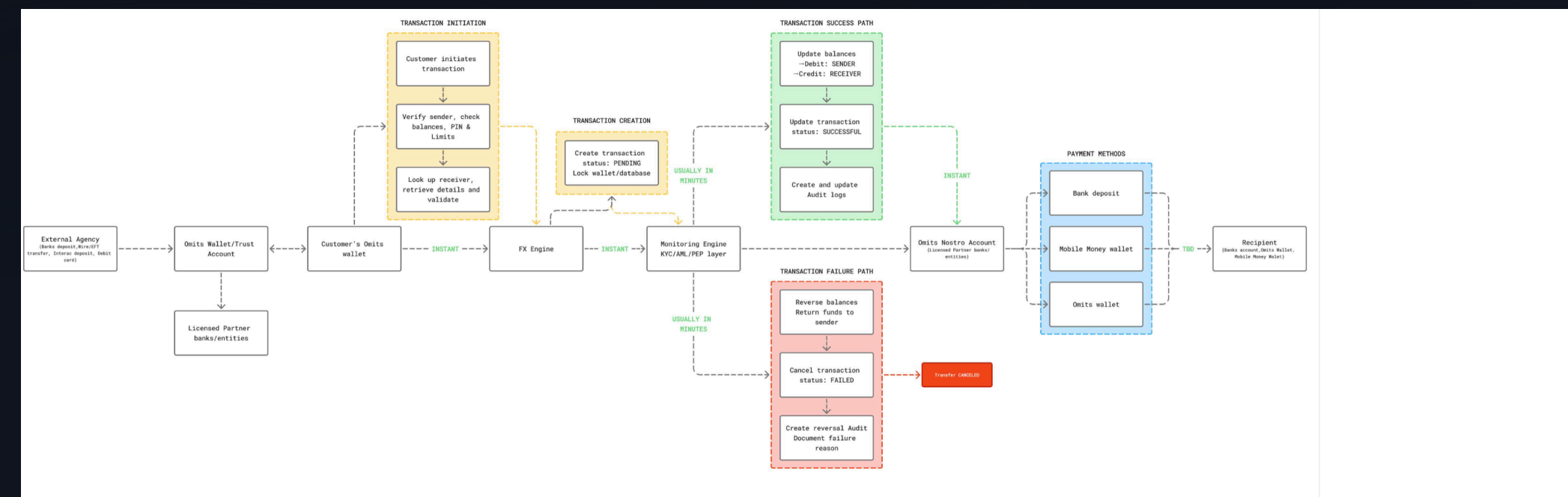
04 Intelligent Assistance

Corridor-aware inputs, real-time banking validation, and clear error recovery states replace generic, intimidating fintech forms.

STRATEGIC INSIGHT

"Trust in fintech is won or lost at the point of commitment. The review step users describe as friction is actually what gives them the confidence to finish, provided all numbers are honest and unambiguous."

Money Flow & System State Machine



Tiered jurisdiction-aware KYC state machine with explicit retry states.

✦ System-First Mapping

Modelled the FX engine, liquidity providers, Nostro accounts, and settlement webhooks before opening Figma to ensure design matched engineering reality.

✦ Reversal & Failure Paths

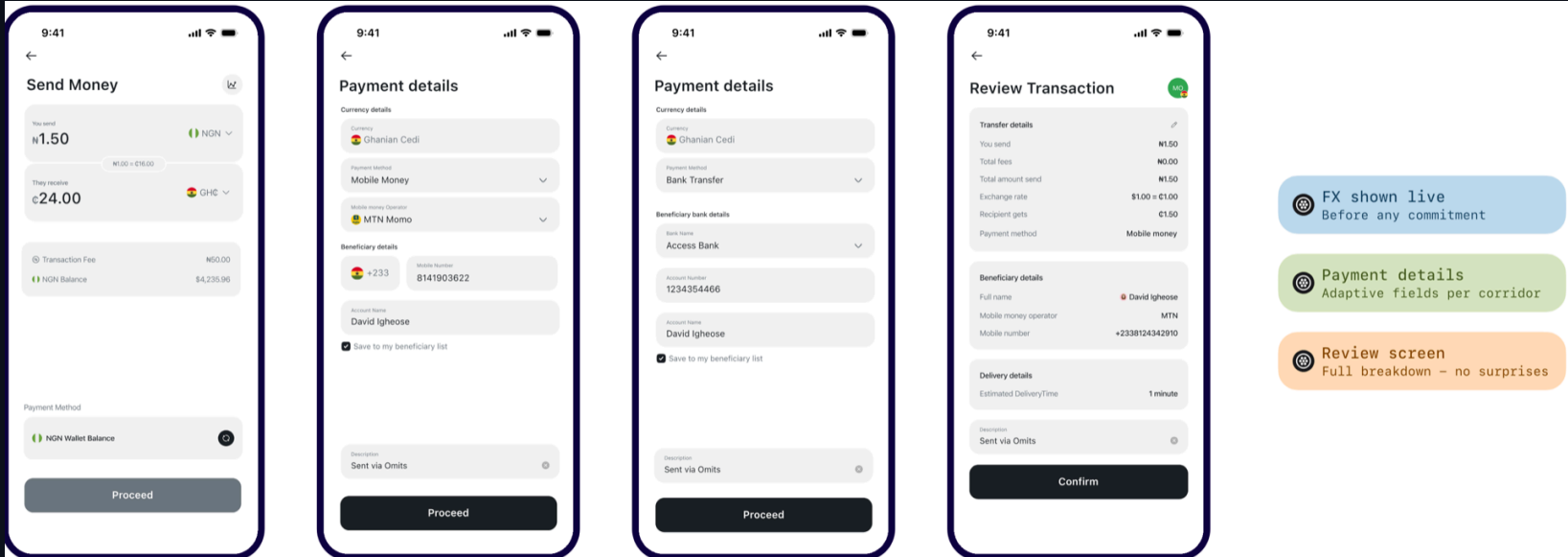
Prioritised failure and reversal branches. When a corridor fails, balances reverse immediately and audit logs explain why, reflected transparently in UI.

✦ Corridor-Aware Adaptability

Different banking rails (NIBSS, Mobile Money, Faster Payments) converge into one predictable review and confirmation state.

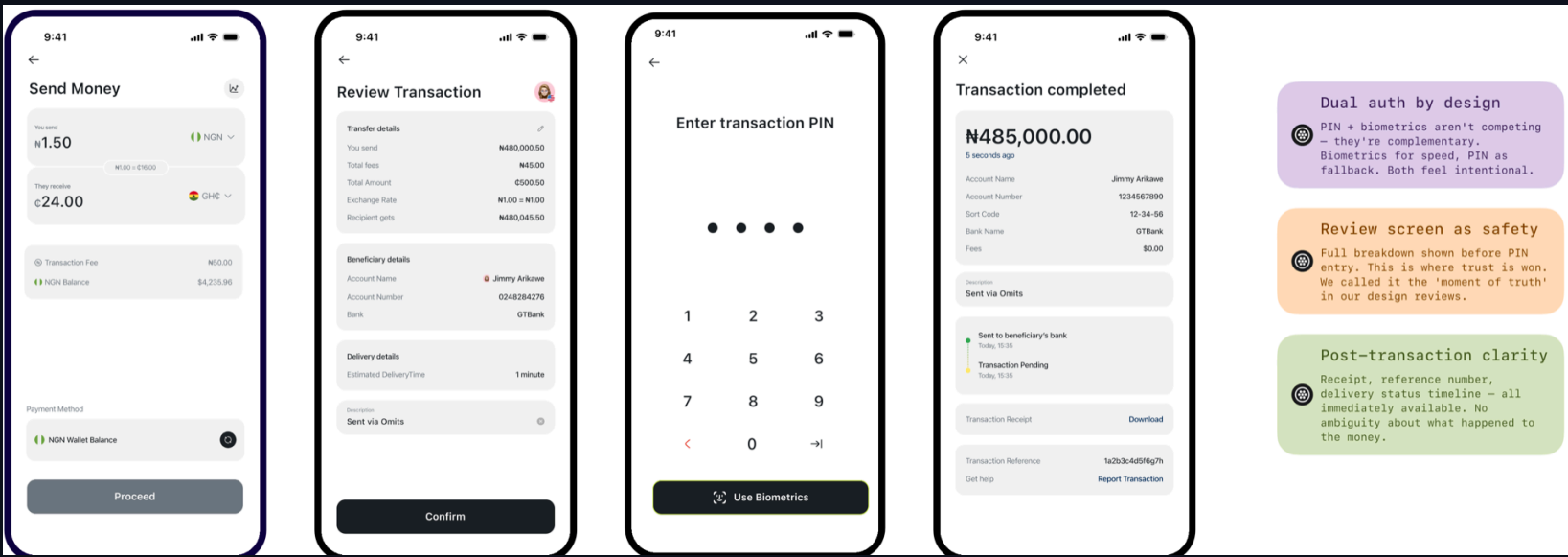
■ INTERFACE HIGHLIGHTS

Core Product Experience & Touchpoints



● Transparency Before Commitment

Review screen reveals the live exchange rate, exact fee breakdown, recipient payout, and estimated arrival before PIN entry. We called this the "Moment of Truth".



● Dual-Layer Authorisation & Receipt

Biometrics carry speed while a transaction PIN provides fallback. On completion, instant transaction reference, PDF receipt, and live status tracker are available.

■ SCALABLE FOUNDATIONS

Tokens, States & Parity

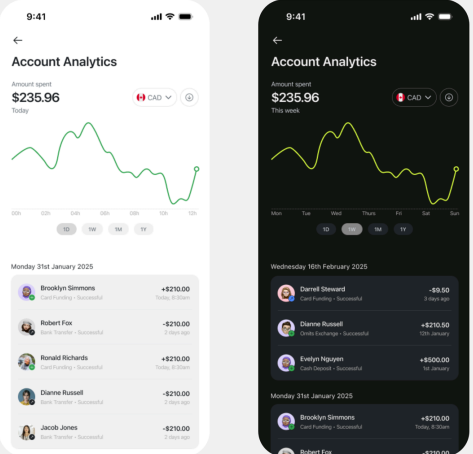
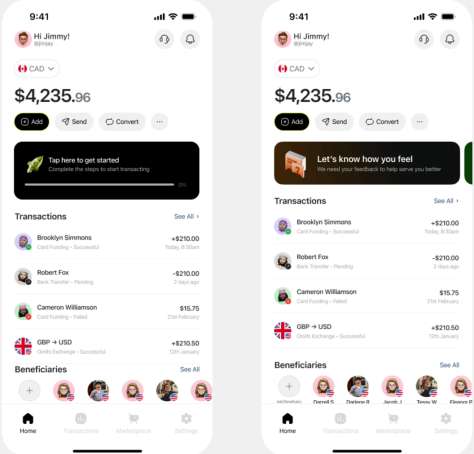
Built a token-based design system with 100% light and dark mode parity. Designed to scale across N currencies and corridors without creating N bespoke screens. Every component state (default, active, loading, error, empty) was documented for zero-ambiguity developer handoff.

◆ System Specifications

- ✓ Semantic risk & status tokens (Success, Pending, Reversed, Failed)
- ✓ Fluid typography hierarchy with large numerical readout priority
- ✓ Light and dark mode parity tested across 40+ responsive screens
- ✓ Component library built for rapid corridor expansion

THE DESIGN ENGINEER ADVANTAGE

Bridging the gap between Figma and production front-end code (React, Next.js, TypeScript). Zero guesswork during developer handoff, pixel-perfect responsive execution, and bulletproof component architectures.



BUSINESS & USER IMPACT

Shipped Outcomes & Measured Results

500+

BETA USERS ONBOARDED

< 60s

TRANSACTION COMPLETION

130s

ONBOARDING COMPLETION

4+

CORRIDORS AT LAUNCH

◆ Validated Project Milestone

Successfully shipped to a 500+ user beta across Canada, Nigeria, Ghana, and the UK. Achieved average transaction times under 60 seconds, cut onboarding time to 130 seconds, and sustained zero critical transaction failures across four live corridors.

◆ Senior Product Reflections

"Design systems are a commercial decision, not just a design aesthetic—our token architecture halved the engineering cost of onboarding new corridors. Trust is designed, not assumed: progressive KYC wasn't just good UX, it was our core conversion funnel strategy."

JA

Jimmy Arikawe

Senior Product Designer & Design Engineer · Ex-Pentagram

AVAILABLE ON UPWORK

◆ End-to-End Product Design (0 to 1)

◆ Design Systems & Component Libraries

◆ Complex SaaS & Enterprise Dashboards

◆ Design Engineering (React / Next.js / TS)

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